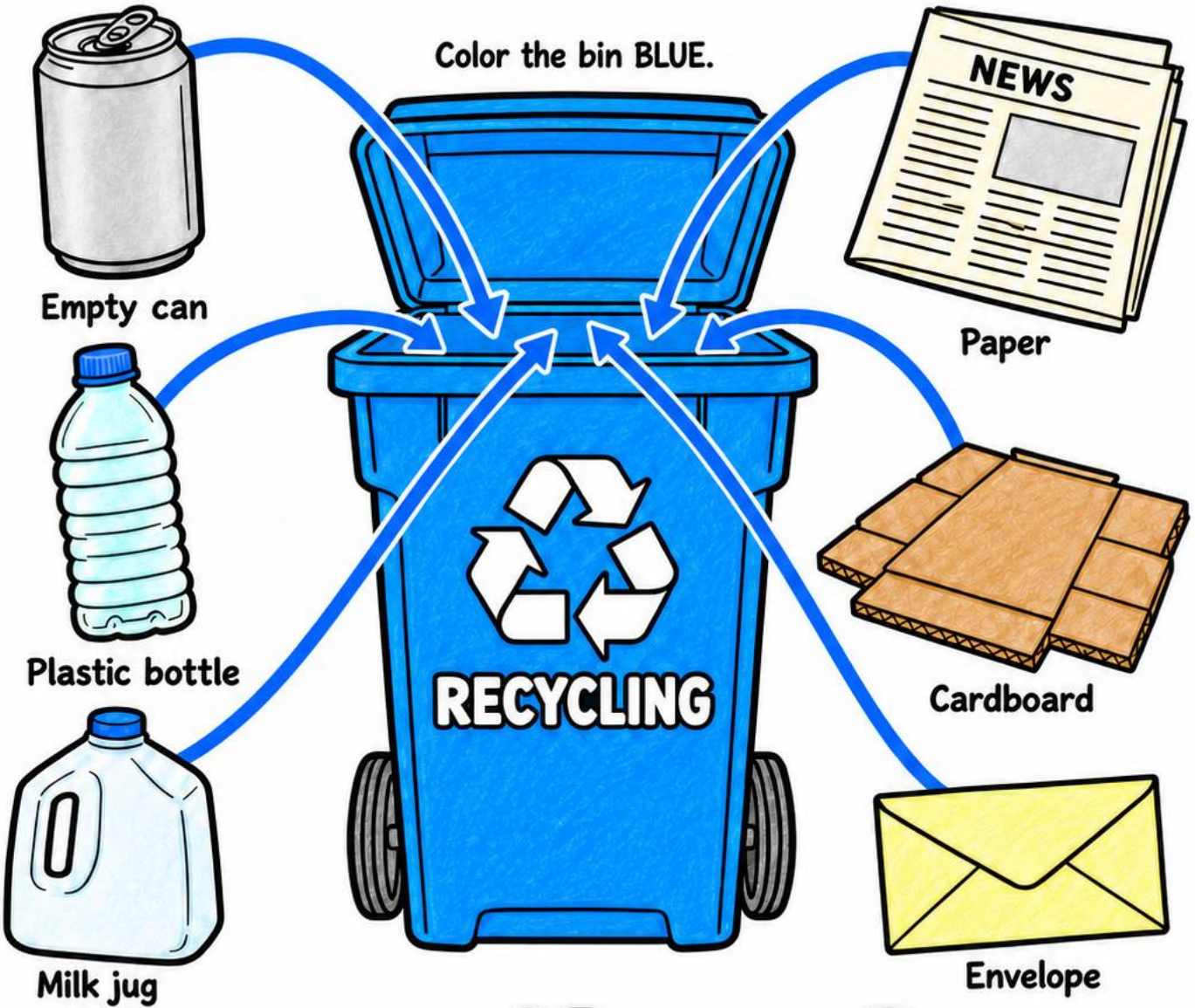
What Goes in Recycling?

Seattle Litter Heroes

Draw a line from each item to the bin. Then color!



Empty. Clean. Dry.

Food scraps go in compost. Ask a grown-up when you are unsure.

Pick It Up Seattle

One person. One piece. One better place.

Seattle Litter Heroes

Recycling Answers

Answer guide for families and educators

Correct items



1. Empty aluminum can
2. Empty plastic bottle
3. Empty plastic milk jug
4. Clean paper or newspaper
5. Clean, flattened cardboard
6. Plain paper envelope

Remember

Color the recycling bin blue.

All six pictured items connect to the recycling bin.

Recycling must be empty, clean, and dry.

Keep recyclables loose, not inside plastic bags.

Reuse tip: Use an old envelope for a shopping list.

Sorting reference: Seattle Public Utilities, How to Sort at Home
seattle.gov/utilities/your-services/collection-and-disposal/how-to-sort-at-home
Seattle guidance checked October 17, 2026. Rules vary by community.